

Business Sales Performance Analytics

1. Project Objective

To analyze business sales data and build an interactive dashboard that helps identify revenue trends, top-performing products, profitable categories and regions, and business growth opportunities for better decision-making.

2. Problem Statement

The business wants to analyze its sales performance to better understand revenue trends, customer purchasing behavior, and profitability. The key business questions addressed in this project are:

1. Which products generate the highest revenue?
2. How do sales change over time?
3. Which product categories and regions are the most profitable?
4. Who are the top customers contributing to overall sales?
5. Where should the business focus its efforts to drive future growth and improve profitability?

3. Attribute (Column / Features):

Attribute Name	Data Type	Description
Order Id	Text	Unique Order number
Order Date	Date	Date when the order was placed
Ship Date	Date	Date when the order was shipped
Ship Mode	Text	Shipping method used
Customer ID	Text	Unique Customer identifier
Customer Name	Text	Name of the customer
Segment	Text	Customer Segment
Product ID	Text	Unique product identifier
Category	Text	Product Category
Sub Category	Text	Product sub category
Product Name	Text	Name of the product
Country	Text	Country where customer

City	Text	Customer city location
State	Text	Customer state location
Region	Text	Business Region (West,East,Central,South)
Sales	Currency	Revenue generated from product sales
Quantity	Number	Number of units sold
Discount	Percentage	Discount provided on sales
Profit	Currency	Profit earned from each transaction
Order Year	Number	Extracted year from order date
Order Month	Text	Extracted month from order date
Shipping Days	Number	Order year - Order month
Discount Status	Text	Indicates whether a discount applied(discounted/No Discount)

4. Tools & Technologies

- **Microsoft Excel** : Data Cleaning, Remove Duplicates,Handle Missing Values, Data Type Validation , Data Modeling (Fact & Dimension Tables)
- **Power BI** : Data Modeling, DAX Measures, Interactive Dashboards, KPI Cards, Data Visualization , Slicers & Filters
- **Git Hub** : Project Documentation, Version Control, Portfolio Showcase

4. Data Pre-Processing

The following data preprocessing steps were performed to ensure data quality and prepare the dataset for analysis:

1. Data Loading

- Imported the cleaned Excel dataset into **Power BI**.
- Verified that all tables were loaded successfully for analysis.

2. Duplicate Handling

- Checked for duplicate records using Excel.
- Removed duplicate rows to ensure data accuracy and consistency.

3. Date Format Standardization

- Standardized **Order Date** and **Ship Date** into a consistent **Date** format.
- Corrected inconsistent date formats before importing into Power BI.

4. Data Type Validation

Validated and assigned appropriate data types for all columns:

- **Text:** Order ID, Customer Name, Category, Product Name, Region, etc.
- **Whole Number:** Row ID, Quantity, Postal Code, Order Year.
- **Decimal Number:** Sales, Profit, Discount.
- **Date:** Order Date, Ship Date.

5. Feature Engineering

Created additional columns to enhance analysis:

- **Order Year** – Extracted from Order Date. = Year(Order Date)
- **Order Month** – Extracted from Order Date. =Text(Order Date,"MMM")
- **Shipping Days** - Difference between date (= Order Date - Ship Date)
- **Discount Status** – Classified orders as *Discounted* or *No Discount* based on the Discount value. =IF(Discount=0,"No Discount","Discount Applied")

6. Data Export

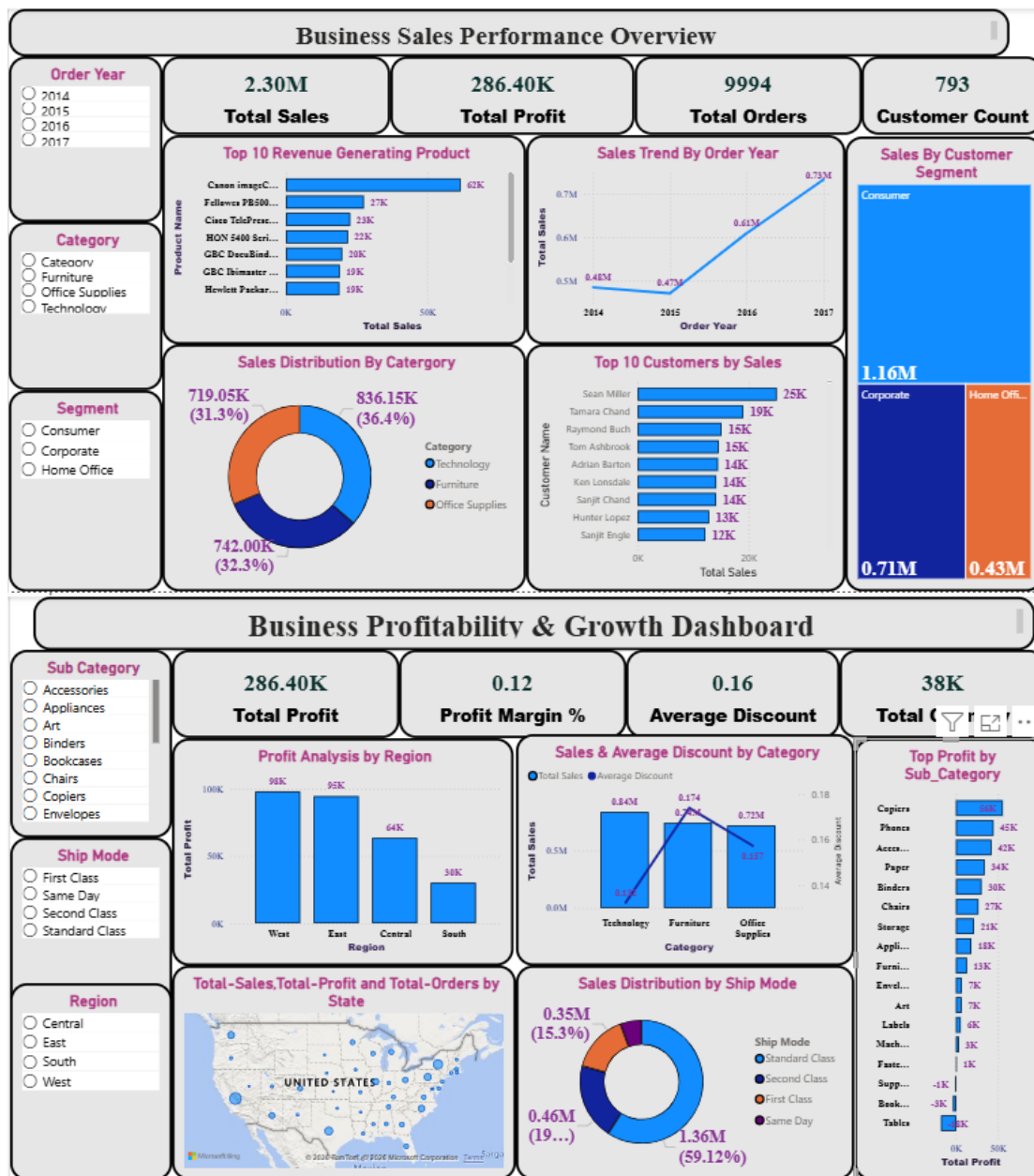
- Built a **star schema** with **Customer Dimension**, **Product Dimension**, and **Orders Fact** tables.
- Exported the cleaned dataset into CSV format for further visualization and dashboard development in Power BI.

5. DAX Formula(Power BI)

1. DAX Measures: Implemented DAX formulas for key metrics
2. Total Sales = **SUM(Orders_Fact[Sales])**
3. Total Profit = **SUM(Orders_Fact[Profit])**
4. Average Discount = **AVERAGE(Orders_Fact[Discount])**
5. Customer Count = **DISTINCTCOUNT(Customer_Dim[Customer Name])**
6. Profit Margin % = **DIVIDE([Total Profit],[Total Sales],0)**

7. Total Orders = `COUNT(Orders_Fact[Order ID])`
8. Total Quantity = `SUM(Orders_Fact[Quantity])`

6. Dashboard



7. Insights

- The business generated \$2.30M in **total sales** with a **total profit** of \$286.40K from 9,994 orders and 793 unique customers.
- Sales showed a consistent upward trend from **2014** to **2017**, indicating steady business growth over time.

- **Technology** emerged as the highest revenue-generating category, making it the key contributor to overall sales.
- The Consumer segment contributed the largest share of sales compared to **Corporate** and **Home Office** customers.
- The **West** region achieved the highest profitability, while the **South** region showed the lowest profit, highlighting opportunities for improvement.
- **Copiers, Phones, and Accessories** were the most profitable sub-categories, whereas Tables and Bookcases generated lower profits.
- **Standard Class** was the most frequently used shipping mode, accounting for the majority of sales.
- Although the business offered an average 16% discount, maintaining an average 12% profit margin indicates balanced pricing and profitability.

8. Recommendation

- **Increase investment in Technology products** as they generate the highest sales and have strong growth potential.
- **Improve sales performance in the South region** by introducing targeted marketing campaigns and strengthening the regional sales strategy.
- **Focus on retaining high-value customers** through loyalty programs and personalized offers to encourage repeat purchases and increase customer lifetime value.
- **Review discount policies for Furniture and other lower-profit categories** to improve profit margins while maintaining sales performance.
- **Maintain adequate inventory for top-selling products and profitable sub-categories** such as Copiers and Phones to avoid stock shortages and maximize revenue opportunities.

9. Conclusion

The analysis revealed consistent sales growth, strong performance from the Technology category, and significant contributions from the Consumer segment and West region. These insights enable the business to optimize sales strategies, improve profitability, and support long-term sustainable growth.